

Native of Cedar City Dies, Services Held

Mrs. Maude Lunt Matheson, 86, native of Cedar City, and one of the last operators on the old Deseret Telegraph Line which connected communities in Utah, Idaho, and Nevada, died Friday afternoon at the home of a son in Cedar City.

Funeral services were conducted in the Cedar Fifth Ward Chapel Monday afternoon, and burial was in the Cedar City cemetery.

Mrs. Matheson was born in Cedar City on Dec. 18, 1875, a daughter of Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt. She married Daniel E. Matheson in the St. George LDS Temple on April 27, 1897. He preceded her in death in December, 1953.

They spent most of their married life in Cedar City, although they lived in the Midvalley area for a number of years.

Surviving Mrs. Matheson are four daughters and three sons: Mrs. Ianthé Harper, Mrs. Erwin (Violet) Stevens, Salt Lake City; Mrs. W. G. (Phyllis) Gilbert, Encino, Calif.; Mrs. William (Mary) Dalton, Casper, Wyo.; Dueane Matheson, Cedar City; Albert Matheson, Summit, and William Matheson, Whittier, Calif.; 27 grandchildren, 40 great-grandchildren; one sister, Mrs. Violet Urie, Cedar City; a half-brother, Heaton Parley Lunt, Duncan, Ariz., and a half-sister, Mrs. Rachael Black, Blanding.

The old telegraph office was located in Mrs. Matheson's home and she started to work with it at a very early age, and continued until the telegraph was discontinued. She became manager of the Cedar City office at the age of 16 years.

Active in the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints, Mrs. Matheson served almost 70 years, as a Relief Society teacher

Conducting the services at the Cedar Fifth Ward Chapel was Bishop's Counselor Frank Holmes.

Prayer at the mortuary prior to the services was by Evan Matheson. Prelude and postlude music at the chapel was furnished by Belle Jones at the organ.

Invocation was by Marvin Jones.

Speakers included Harry Lunt and Barbara Adams, with sentiments of the life of Mrs. Matheson given by Mattie Booth and remarks by Bp. Holmes.

Musical numbers included a mixed quartet singing "Lead Me Gently Home," consisting of Lois McConnell, Mamie Eck, Herschel Neeley and Wm. Condie, accompanied by Beth Leigh; a vocal duet, "My Father Knows," by George D. Grimshaw and Elwin Armstrong accompanied by Maurine Grimshaw, and a viola solo by Francis Webster, accompanied by Mrs. Parson U. Webster.

Benediction was by Walter G. Lunt with the grave at the Cedar City cemetery, dedicated by Edward G. Matheson.